STARTPAD | FINANCIAL MODEL ON ONE PAGE

# One Million First-Time Founders: how the money works

1,000,000 Pro seats at $10 each. March to August 2027, preparation from November 2026. All figures in USD, modelled from stated assumptions.

**1. VOLUME**

**1,000,000**

registered founders, each with a Pro seat. 500,000 seeded by partners, 500,000 through referrals.

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**2. REVENUE**

**$10.0M**

sponsors pay: 1,000,000 seats x $10 per seat.

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**3. OUR COST**

**$1.02M**

to deliver, before our margin: $1.02 per seat.

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**4. SURPLUS**

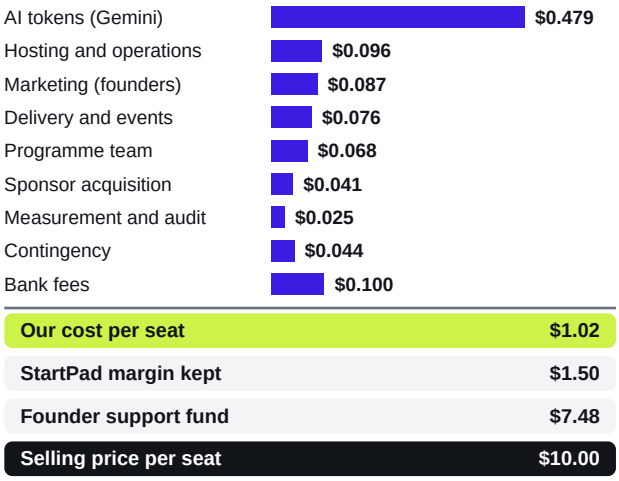
**$8.98M**

StartPad keeps $1.5M (15%). The other $7.5M is a founder support fund.

## HOW THE MODEL WORKS

1. **Volume and revenue.**
   Every registered founder gets a Pro seat that a sponsor pays for. Revenue is simply seats x price, so it moves one for one with the price you choose.
2. **Cost is built bottom up.**
   Nine groups of cost add to $1,016,372: AI tokens 47%, hosting and operations 9%, marketing and sponsor acquisition 13%, learning delivery and events 8%, team 7%, measurement and audit 2%, contingency and bank fees 14%.
3. **Fixed versus variable.**
   Most cost is fixed or tied to registrations, so cost per seat falls as volume grows. Only AI use by activated founders grows with seats.
4. **Our margin.**
   We keep 15% of what sponsors pay. Anything above that is reinvested in founders, not retained.
5. **Price test.**
   Break-even price is $0.93 and the price that gives a 15% margin is $1.09, so $10 is about 10 times our cost. The workbook tests every price from $1 to $15 and ten stress cases.

## WHAT ONE SEAT COSTS US, AND THE $10 PRICE (USD)

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|---|---|
| **Our cost per seat** | **$1.02** |
| **StartPad margin kept** | **$1.50** |
| **Founder support fund** | **$7.48** |
| **Selling price per seat** | **$10.00** |

### AI IS A PRODUCT COST: GEMINI TOKENS

Reviews and coaching use a fast model ($0.25 in / $1.50 out per 1M tokens); AI tools and builds use a strong model ($1.50 / $9.00). Thinking tokens are billed as output, plus a 25% buffer.

Cost per founder: inactive $0.01, starter $0.14, light $0.37, moderate $2.02, heavy $8.09.

Heavy founders are 2.7% of all founders but 46% of AI spend. Total: 340 billion tokens, $478,735.

### MARKETING: WHAT A FOUNDER COSTS TO WIN

User acquisition $87,000 across six channels plus $41,200 to win sponsors: 13% of our cost.

$0.087 per registered founder, $0.39 per activated founder, $0.004 per $1 sponsors pay.

Partner media is free; the referral loop brings 500,000 founders at no extra spend.

### IMPACT: WHERE 10,000 BUSINESSES COME FROM

225,000 founders finish Missions 01 to 03. By type: light 108,000 x 0.5%, moderate 90,000 x 3.2%, heavy 27,000 x 25%.

= 10,170 running businesses at month 12, 102% of the 10,000 target, 30,510 jobs, $81M turnover and $28M value added in year 1.

Rates are estimates; a pilot of 1,000 founders would measure them.

## THE LOGIC BEHIND THE KEY ASSUMPTIONS

**Funnel**
45% finish Mission 01, then 50% of those finish Mission 03: 225,000 activated founders. Free, online, no facilitator, so cautious.

**Founder types**
Of activated founders 48% light, 40% moderate, 12% heavy (27,000 finish all 15 missions). Each type has its own AI use and business rate.

**Gemini prices**
Reported list prices; thinking tokens billed as output; 25% buffer. Prices change, so a price multiplier is a stress lever.

**Conversion**
Share who run a business: 0.5% light, 3.2% moderate, 25% heavy. The further a founder gets, the likelier they launch.

## WHAT COULD GO WRONG, AND WHAT THE BOARD DECIDES

Cost is not the main risk. In the combined stress case (heavy AI use, Gemini prices up 50%, 30% fewer registrations, 30% of seats unfunded, marketing and fixed cost overruns, weaker conversion) the surplus is still 69%; with only half the seats funded it is 81%.

The real risks are: (1) sponsors must fund $10M, which is about ten times our cost; (2) the share of heavy founders who launch a business (25%) is the least certain assumption; (3) heavy AI users and Gemini price changes.

Decisions: (a) keep $10, or lower the price (the cost-plus price is $1.09); (b) approve how the $7.5M founder support fund is used (seed grants, launch support, mentoring, prizes); (c) fund a 1,000 founder pilot to measure AI use and business conversion before launch.

Source: StartPad_1Mn_Initiative_Budget_v4.xlsx (every figure is a live formula there). Results are modelled from stated assumptions, not measured.
Gemini prices are reported list prices; verify at ai.google.dev/pricing before launch.